

IKENNA OKWARA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Innovative and dedicated certified AWS Solution Architect and DevOps Engineer with 8+ years of experience in designing, automating, and securing cloud infrastructures. Proficient in architecting scalable, high-availability solutions, implementing Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC), and integrating CI/CD pipelines to optimize application delivery. Adept at enhancing security, ensuring compliance, and leading cloud migration initiatives. Proven ability to collaborate across teams, foster innovation, and drive business outcomes in dynamic, high-pressure environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND TOOLS

- **Data Protection:** AWS Certificate Manager, AWS KMS, Snapshot Lifecycle Manager, AWS CloudHSM, AWS Secrets Manager, AWS Macie.
- **DevOps Tools:** Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Ansible, Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana, Spinnaker, ArgoCD, Packer, Chef, Puppet, Bamboo, Harness.
- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, ECS, EKS, CloudFormation, VPC, CloudFront, Route 53, Redshift, Glue), Azure (VMs, Azure DevOps, Blob Storage, Functions).
- **Databases:** DynamoDB, Amazon RDS, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB, Redis. Google Cloud Platform (GCP).
- **Languages:** Python, Bash, YAML, JSON, Java, GoLang, Ruby, Shell Scripting, TypeScript.
- **Version Control:** Git, GitLab, GitHub, Bitbucket, SVN.
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, AWS CodePipeline, Spinnaker, Harness, Bamboo, CircleCI, Azure Pipelines.
- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC):** Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Packer, Ansible, Pulumi, SaltStack, AWS CDK.
- **Containerization & Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes (EKS, OpenShift, AKS, GKE), Mesos, Nomad, Helm, Istio, Service Mesh.
- **Programming Languages:** JSON, YAML, and Python.
- **Application Delivery and DevOps:** Jira, Confluence, Jenkins, AWS CodePipeline, AWS CodeCommit, AWS CodeBuild, AWS CodeDeploy.
- **Networking:** AWS VPC, Transit Gateway, Internet Gateway, NAT Gateway, VPN Gateway, Direct Connect.
- **AWS Migration Tools:** CART, AWS Application Discovery Service (ADS), AWS Migration Hub, AWS Application Migration Service (MGN), AWS Database Migration Service (DMS), AWS Schema Conversion Tool (SCT).
- **Access Management & AWS Security:** AWS IAM, AWS Organizations, AWS Secrets Manager, AWS Security Hub, GuardDuty, AWS Shield, AWS Firewall Manager, HashiCorp Vault.
- **Monitoring & Logging:** AWS CloudWatch, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), Splunk, Datadog.
- **Governance & Compliance:** AWS Config, AWS Control Tower, AWS Trusted Advisor, AWS Well-Architected Tool, AWS Budgets.
- **Other Tools:** Jira, Confluence, Snyk, SonarQube, Artifactory, Nexus, Vault, Consul, Istio, ArgoCD.

WORK HISTORY

AWS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT | DEVOPS ENGINEER – 10/2021 to Present

Volvo CE, Shippensburg, PA

- Saved the team over \$50,000 annually by automating CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and GitLab, making deployments faster and more reliable.
- Worked closely with developers to create cloud-based solutions for Java applications, focusing on scalability, security, and ensuring compliance with Zero Trust principles.
- Led the migration of legacy applications to serverless architectures using AWS Lambda, API Gateway, and DynamoDB, improving performance and scalability.
- Enhanced system reliability, preventing potential losses of \$100,000 annually by implementing high-availability solutions with Auto Scaling Groups and Load Balancers.
- Optimized AWS resources, saving \$150,000 annually through smart use of AWS Cost Explorer, tagging policies, and Reserved Instances.
- Deployed Kubernetes clusters (EKS) to containerize and orchestrate microservices, ensuring they were both scalable and efficient.
- Automated resource provisioning with Terraform and CloudFormation, ensuring consistent deployments across multiple environments.
- Built disaster recovery solutions using AWS Backup and cross-region replication, achieving recovery times of less than 15 minutes.
- Improved system observability by integrating AWS CloudWatch, Datadog, and the ELK Stack, which helped reduce downtime and improve our incident response times.
- Implemented security measures using AWS IAM, RBAC, and MFA, ensuring secure access to cloud resources.
- Integrated HashiCorp Vault for secure credential management, enhancing security across our DevOps pipelines.
- Mentored junior engineers, helping them develop a strong foundation in AWS and cloud-native applications, and fostering a collaborative team environment.

AWS CLOUD ENGINEER | DEVOPS ENGINEER – 06/2018 to 09/2021

COFCO, Philadelphia, PA.

- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Jenkins, improving deployment efficiency and minimizing errors, saving over \$50,000 annually in development time.
- Implemented real-time monitoring with AWS CloudWatch, Prometheus, and ELK Stack, resolving critical incidents faster and reducing downtime costs.
- Designed and deployed secure, scalable AWS solutions using EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, and CloudFormation to support high-availability applications.
- Improved system reliability and traffic management by architecting high-availability solutions with Auto Scaling, ELB, and Route 53.
- Migrated workloads to AWS using AWS MGN and DMS, ensuring minimal downtime and a seamless transition to cloud environments.
- Enhanced application performance, saving \$75,000 annually, by migrating monolithic applications to microservices with AWS Lambda and API Gateway.
- Optimized cloud resources, reducing costs by \$150,000 annually, through AWS Cost Explorer, Trusted Advisor, and Reserved Instances.

- Implemented IAM policies, AWS Secrets Manager, and GuardDuty to improve security posture and automate threat detection.
- Established continuous compliance monitoring using AWS Security Hub, Config, and GuardDuty, aligning infrastructure with security standards.
- Automated daily backups with AWS S3 and implemented disaster recovery strategies with AWS Backup to ensure data integrity and business continuity.
- Configured VPCs, Security Groups, and Network ACLs to build secure, efficient network architectures across AWS environments.
- Integrated Datadog and New Relic for advanced monitoring, enhancing system visibility and reducing response times for critical incidents.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments and audits to maintain compliance and secure infrastructure against evolving threats.
- Optimized storage and cost management by configuring AWS EFS and S3 lifecycle policies for streamlined data management.
- Collaborated with stakeholders and cross-functional teams to align cloud initiatives with organizational goals, driving successful implementations.
- Automated patch management and updates with AWS Systems Manager, ensuring compliance with security standards.
- Proactively monitored trends and emerging technologies, implementing best practices to drive informed decision-making and system improvements.

DEVOPS ENGINEER – 03/2016 to 05/2018

Covance, Princeton, NJ

- Managed AWS infrastructure, including EC2, RDS, S3, and CloudFront, to support high-availability production workloads.
- Collaborated with security teams to implement AWS security best practices, including encryption for data-at-rest and in-transit using KMS and SSL.
- Developed serverless workflows with AWS Lambda and API Gateway, streamlining operations and reducing infrastructure costs by 40%.
- Designed disaster recovery strategies leveraging Route 53, S3 Cross-Region Replication, and Elastic Load Balancers, ensuring business continuity.
- Led the migration of monolithic applications to microservices architectures, leveraging Docker, Kubernetes, and AWS EKS.
- Worked closely with developers to implement automated testing and continuous integration pipelines, reducing release times by 50%.
- Configured logging and monitoring solutions using ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, and Kibana) to improve troubleshooting and incident response.
- Implemented Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) using Terraform and AWS CloudFormation for automating the provisioning and management of AWS resources.
- Automated CI/CD workflows using Jenkins and Ansible, increasing deployment frequency and reliability.
- Deployed containerized applications using Docker and Kubernetes (EKS), enabling rapid scaling and enhanced system performance.

- Monitored and maintained cloud environments using AWS CloudWatch, Prometheus, and Grafana to ensure optimal performance and uptime.
- Integrated third-party tools, such as HashiCorp Vault, for secure secrets management in CI/CD pipelines.
- Configured AWS IAM roles and policies to enforce the principle of least privilege for securing access to cloud resources.
- Designed secure VPC architectures with subnets, security groups, and NAT Gateways for optimized network segmentation.
- Performed regular performance tuning of cloud infrastructure, identifying and addressing bottlenecks to improve system scalability.
- Maintained version control systems like Git or SVN for seamless collaboration among developers and engineers during project lifecycles.
- Automated manual tasks through scripting languages such as Python or Shell, boosting team productivity levels.
- Configured monitoring and alerting for Java applications using AWS CloudWatch and Datadog, ensuring real-time insights and minimizing downtime for production environments.
- Contributed to the creation of a DevOps culture within the organization, leading to increased agility and cross-functional collaboration.
- Implemented logging and monitoring solutions with ELK Stack and AWS CloudWatch to improve observability and troubleshooting.
- Optimized build processes using tools such as Jenkins or Bamboo for fast feedback loops in development cycles.
- Mitigated security risks by conducting regular vulnerability assessments and applying necessary patches.
- Provided 24/7 on-call support for critical systems, ensuring high availability and rapid issue resolution.

LINUX ENGINEER – 09/2014 to 02/2016

Covance, Princeton, NJ

- Administered Linux servers and systems for a large semiconductor company.
- Configured and maintained web servers, database servers, and DNS servers.
- Troubleshoot system issues and provide timely solutions to ensure business continuity.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to implement new solutions and ensure system integration.

EDUCATION

- Associate in arts, Health Care Studies
Community College of Philadelphia, PA | 2021.
- Bachelor of Science, Industrial Physics
Anambra State University Uli, Anambra State, Nigeria | 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate.

- CompTIA Security+ in process.